

i am

what i

am

Stories of an
ordinary teen girl
and her rising in
fame



23/5/2012



Introduction

Hey! I'm Chloe and I'm an ordinary teen girl. My grades are flunking, but my skills are acing. I feel understood only with my friends....

Here are my crocheting designs:

- Bears
- teddies
- clothes
- bags

<https://teenchloe.portofolio.com>

1- I'm so dramatic?

My teachers always get angry for my portofolio in crocheting business. My mom is only buying me test books for my high school exam. Oh and I am an eight grader. I always forget to say this. It isn't my fault; I don't depend on school! Since life is based on money. And I'm using this advantage. I wanna make bedsheets when I grow up but my mom wants me to be a doctor! Once I was texting Molly about how the weather was supposed to be nice today but it was bad. My mom said:

– Go and study! Now! Or else you will never be rich.

– Ugh...

And I pretended I was studying on my phone but I was actually texting my secret therapist friend Jessica and telling the situation to Molly because this type of pressure is too much for a teenager. We know better than our parents now.. How hilarious!

I just study and work like a concubine! While everyone else is doing parties and getting rich while sleepin'.

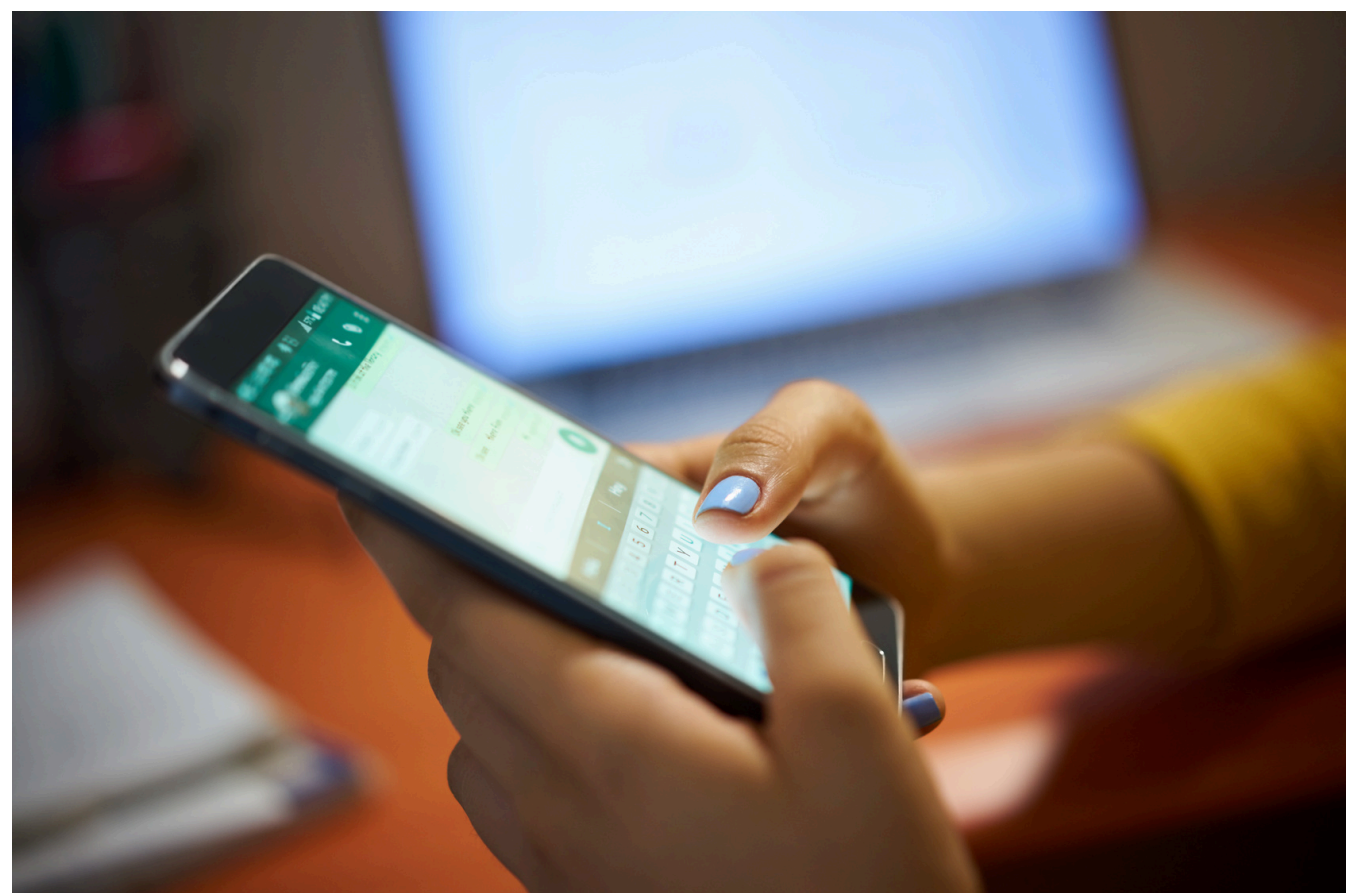


2- Nobody understands us...

I was playing the guitar and my parents were fixing the car. My mom came in and said Don't play the guitar and I said it was low volume but she didn't listen so I played louder and she took it. I threw a teen-style tantrum at her, yelled and threw the curtains away. Sometimes they need to listen to us and say to us rationally because we're teens but we're not super smart... We cannot think rationally when we get emotional. I'm saying one sentence:



We're not sassy.



3- The Hormones

Fairytale

I woke up feeling like a literal goddess. My hair did that perfect "effortless" wave thing, my eyeliner was symmetrical on the first try, and I actually understood what was happening in Physics. I remember thinking, "I've cracked it. I'm finally an adult. I am the master of my own destiny."

I was so wrong.

It started at 11:15 AM in the school canteen. The girl behind the counter told me they were out of spicy chicken wraps.

Normally? Fine. I'll have the tuna. But Tuesday-Chloe? Tuesday-Chloe felt a hot surge of lightning travel from my toes to my ears. I felt like she had personally waited for me to get to the front of the queue just to spite me. I didn't say anything, but I sat down and stared at my tuna sandwich with such intense, vibrating fury that my best friend, Jas, actually moved her drink away from me.

"You okay, Chlo?" she asked. "I'm fine," I snapped. Then, because her face looked so genuinely concerned, I burst into tears. Right there. Into the tuna.

Wednesday was worse because the anger turned into a weird, itchy sensitivity.

- My school jumper felt like it was made of steel wool and spiders.
- The sound of my dad chewing his cereal downstairs felt like a jackhammer inside my skull.
- I saw a TikTok of a golden retriever successfully fetching a ball, and I sobbed for ten minutes because "he was trying so hard."

My hormones weren't just "shifting"; they were throwing a rave in my brain and I wasn't invited. I felt like a stranger in my own skin. I looked in the mirror and didn't see Chloe; I saw a red-eyed, puffy-faced creature who was one "How was your day?" away from a total meltdown.



I convinced myself everyone hated me. Jas hadn't liked my Instagram post from three hours ago. Obviously, she was bored of me. My BFF, Leo, walked past me in the hall and said "Hey," but he didn't smile with his eyes. Clearly, he thought I looked like a swamp monster.

I went home, crawled under my duvet, and stayed there. I wasn't even sad anymore; I was just... hollow. I felt like a phone battery stuck at 1%. I ate an entire bag of salt and vinegar crisps and felt like I was the lead character in a very tragic indie movie.

I woke up and the "static" in my brain was gone.

It was like someone had finally turned off a loud vacuum cleaner in the next room. I looked at the mountain of crisp packets and the damp tissues on my nightstand and felt a bit embarrassed. I checked my phone.

Jas: "Hey, I figured you were having 'The Week.' I've got chocolate and that weird face mask you like. Coming over at 6?"

I felt a massive wave of relief. My brain wasn't broken; it was just... recalibrating. I realized that for three days, my internal chemistry had been hijacking the steering wheel.

I went downstairs. My mum looked at me, saw my face, and just pushed a cup of tea toward me. "Better?" she asked. "Better," I said. "Sorry about the door-slamming on Wednesday." "I didn't even notice," she lied beautifully.

4-One mark, one destiny.

The fluorescent lights in the school hallway felt like they were vibrating. I stared down at the paper in my hand, my vision blurring.

42%. The big, red "F" at the top of the page looked like it was screaming at me. All those hours of tutoring, the flashcards, the tears over long division—all for a failing grade. To my sixteen-year-old brain, that letter wasn't just a grade; it was a prophecy. It meant I was a failure, that I'd never get into a good uni, and that I was destined to live in my parents' basement forever.

I sprinted to the girls' toilets, locked myself in the end cubicle, and just let go. I sobbed so hard my chest hurt. I felt like I was drowning in a sea of x and y variables that made absolutely no sense to me. My hormones made everything feel ten times more dramatic—I wasn't just sad; I was mourning the "successful life" I thought I'd just lost.

"Chloe? Are you in there?" It was my friend, Mia.

"Go away," I choked out. "I'm stupid. I'm going to be poor and miserable."

Building an empire isn't just about having a pretty face; it's about having a "math-test-fail" level of spite turned into pure, unadulterated ambition. People think modeling is just standing still, but I treated it like a hostile takeover.

Here is how I went from the girl crying in the school toilets to the CEO of my own brand.

When I first moved to London at eighteen, I lived in a "model flat" in Bethnal Green with six other girls. It smelled like hairspray and cheap noodles. While the other girls were out partying, I was staying in, studying the industry.

- The Strategy: I didn't just look at the clothes; I looked at the credits. I memorized the names of every photographer, stylist, and creative director.
- The Pivot: I realized early on that a model is a "product." If I wanted to be a "brand," I needed to be more than just a face. I started asking questions on set: "Why that lighting?" "Who is the target demographic for this brand?"

The turning point came when I reached 500k followers on Instagram. Usually, agencies tell you what to post, but I took total control.

I started a series called "The F-Grade Diaries." I posted high-fashion shots alongside stories of my biggest failures—the math tests, the casting rejections, the days I felt like a "swamp monster."

- The Result: It went viral. People didn't just want to look at me; they wanted to be in my gang. I wasn't just a silent mannequin anymore; I was a voice.

I knew modeling had an expiration date, so I used my first big "Vogue" paycheck (which was massive) not on a sports car, but on investments.

1. Chloe Beauty: I launched a skincare line specifically for "hormonal skin." I remembered how much I hated my skin at sixteen, so I created the products I wish I'd had.
2. The Agency: I started a boutique agency that scouts girls who don't fit the "standard" mold—the geeks, the rebels, and the girls who feel like they're failing.
3. Real Estate: I started buying properties in East London and Leeds. Every time I signed a deed, I thought about that red "F" on my paper.

The Empire Today

Now, my day starts at 5:00 AM. I'm checking manufacturing reports from Seoul, approving ad copy for my London office, and preparing for a board meeting.

I have a team of "Math Geniuses" working for me now. I pay them very well to handle the spreadsheets I still can't stand. I remember my old teacher saying, "Chloe, you need to focus, or you'll never make anything of yourself." I didn't focus on the math. I focused on the vision.

I stepped out of a black town car in the middle of Manhattan, the crisp morning air catching the silk of my trench coat. My phone buzzed in my pocket—a notification from my banking app. Another six-figure wire transfer from the luxury campaign I'd shot in Paris last month had just cleared.

I looked up at the giant digital billboard overlooking Times Square. There I was. My face, forty feet tall, wearing a pair of emerald earrings that cost more than my parents' house in Leeds.

My life looks nothing like that math test predicted. It turns out, the world doesn't care if you can solve a quadratic equation when you have a "look" that sells out a fashion line in three minutes. After that failing grade, I stopped trying to force myself into a box that didn't fit. I leaned into my height, my "weird" features, and my obsession with style. I moved to London, got scouted in Covent Garden, and worked my absolute soul off.

I'm not just a model now; I'm a brand. I have a team of accountants to do the math for me (and thank God for that, because I still can't calculate a 15% tip without a struggle).

I recently found that old math paper in a box at my mum's house. I looked at the red ink and the tear stains, and I didn't feel sad anymore. I felt proud. If I hadn't failed at being what everyone else wanted me to be, I never would have had the courage to become who I actually am.

I'm rich, I'm successful, and I'm proof that a "fail" in one thing is often just a "start" in another.

5- All about YOU

You are who you are. Don't let the world make you chase it, make the world chase you. One mark doesn't matter, one vision does. Write your own vision and stories here:

I am Queen _____.

I read this book

and I now

understand

making visions

and teenager

needs

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